

Under the Broom Tree

Elijah, Depression, and the God Who Still Speaks

Chukwuma Theology | May 3, 2026

This sermon draft treats 1 Kings 19 as a deeply pastoral text about collapse after victory, showing that even Elijah could move from fire on Carmel to despair under a broom tree. The Adventist burden of the message is that God ministers to the whole person, speaks without coercion, preserves a remnant we cannot always see, and restores exhausted servants to hope and mission. The central call is for discouraged believers to come honestly to God and for the church to become a community that brings bread, rest, presence, and truth instead of shame.

Sermon Frame

Primary text: 1 Kings 19:1–18

Theme: God does not abandon His exhausted servants; He meets them tenderly, corrects their distorted vision, and restores them to hope and mission.

Preaching burden: Spiritual victory does not make us invulnerable, and seasons of depression, burnout, and despair are not proof that God has left us.

Opening hymn: What a Friend We Have in Jesus

Closing hymn: He Hideth My Soul

Sermon Hook

Sometimes the devil does not attack you before Mount Carmel. He waits until after the fire has fallen, after the prayer has been answered, after everybody around you assumes you should be strong. And some of the deepest collapses in life happen not in open defeat, but in the strange silence that can follow a public victory.

Big Idea

When Elijah collapses under the broom tree, God does not answer his despair with shame. He answers with care, presence, truth, and a future.

40-Minute Sermon Outline

Introduction — After the fire, the crash (5 minutes)

- Connect with the experience of emotional collapse after visible success
- Name the text: Elijah after Mount Carmel
- Clarify the sermon's tone: not simplistic, not anti-medical, not shaming
- State the big idea

I. Even prophets can break down (8 minutes)

- 1 Kings 19:1–4
- Elijah moves from triumph to fear, flight, isolation, and death-wish language
- Spiritual usefulness does not equal emotional invincibility
- Adventist application: remnant people are not superhuman people

II. God cares for the whole person before He corrects the prophet (8 minutes)

- 1 Kings 19:5–8
- Food, water, sleep, touch, and time
- God addresses Elijah's body before addressing Elijah's theology
- Adventist application: whole-person ministry matters — body, mind, and spirit belong together

III. God is not always in the earthquake; sometimes He is in the whisper (8 minutes)

- 1 Kings 19:9–13
- The wind, earthquake, and fire are spectacular, but the healing word comes quietly
- Great Controversy emphasis: God's government is not built on coercion, noise, or manipulation
- God still speaks to discouraged people, often gently

IV. God corrects Elijah's isolation and restores his mission (8 minutes)

- 1 Kings 19:14–18
- Elijah says, "I alone am left"
- God reveals the seven thousand and gives Elijah fresh assignment
- Adventist application: the remnant is bigger than your despair can see

Appeal — Come out from under the broom tree (3 minutes)

- Call the discouraged to honesty before God
- Call the church to become the kind of community that feeds and listens
- Call hearers to receive God's whisper and return to faithful mission

Full Sermon Draft

Introduction

Church, have you ever noticed that some of the hardest moments in life come after the moment everybody else calls your victory?

After the exam is passed.

After the child is born.

After the campaign succeeds.

After the sermon is preached.

After the prayer meeting is powerful.

After the fire falls.

There are times when we think the greatest danger is before the breakthrough. But in 1 Kings 19 the danger comes after the breakthrough. Elijah has just stood on Mount Carmel and watched the Lord answer by fire. He has seen false worship exposed. He has seen the name of God vindicated. He has seen rain return after drought. If anybody should feel spiritually strong, it should be Elijah.

But in the next chapter, the prophet who stood before kings cannot stand before his own despair.

That is why this passage matters.

It matters because some believers have quietly concluded that if their faith were stronger, they would never feel this low. Some have concluded that if they were really spiritual, they would never feel this tired, this anxious, this alone, this mentally overwhelmed. And because of that lie, suffering becomes heavier than it already is. You are not only hurting; you are ashamed that you are hurting.